

Ricky Circelli

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EDUCATION

University of South Carolina

Bachelor of Science; Major: Finance (Darla Moore School of Business)
Second Major: Data Science (College of Arts & Sciences); GPA: 4.0

Columbia, SC

Aug. 2024 – May 2028

- **Honors and Involvement:** President’s List (4x), NCAA CSC Academic All-District Team, SEC Academic Honor Roll, South Carolina Honors College
- **Relevant Coursework:** Statistical Methods I & II, Applied Statistics, Computing for Data Science, Data Analytics, Algorithmic Design I, Corporate Financial Analysis
- **Certification:** IBM Data Science Professional Certificate; Microsoft Power BI Data Analyst (PL-300); Claude Certified Architect (CCA-F)

INTERCOLLEGIATE ATHLETICS

University of South Carolina Men’s Track & Field

Student-Athlete

Columbia, SC

Aug. 2024 - Present

- Balance a 4.0 GPA while competing as an NCAA Division I student-athlete, training approximately 25 hours per week as a middle-distance runner (800m, 1500m)

EXPERIENCE

Ally Financial

Quantitative Modeling Intern

Charlotte, NC

May 2026 - August 2026

- Developed an end-to-end machine learning credit risk model for auto lending across 200,000+ loan applications and 2,000+ variables, owning the full pipeline from raw data through model evaluation
- Modeled both booked and unbooked application populations, applying reject inference to correct selection bias and improve out-of-sample predictive accuracy
- Reduced a 2,000+ variable set to its most predictive drivers via feature engineering, Information Value (IV) analysis, and correlation reduction, lowering model complexity without sacrificing accuracy
- Trained and evaluated XGBoost, LightGBM, CatBoost, and Random Forest models in Python and Snowflake, validating performance with AUC, KS, log loss, calibration, and SHAP explainability

Varsity Stack

Founder

Columbia, SC

February 2026 - Present

- Founded and built an AI-powered athlete supplement intelligence platform, leading product, engineering, and go-to-market end to end
- Shipped full-stack mobile and web products to production solo, using Claude Code, LLM APIs, and AI-assisted workflows to cut build timelines from months to weeks
- Integrated wearable and health data with large language models to deliver personalized supplement recommendations and track their impact on athlete performance
- Named Top 5 Finalist in the SEC Startup Competition while growing past 1,000+ downloads, onboarding 2 teams, and converting paying users into recurring subscription revenue

PROJECTS

AI Portfolio Optimizer - Independent Project

May 2025 - July 2025

- Built an AI-powered robo-advisor using Python, Plaid APIs, and Monte Carlo simulation to generate personalized ETF portfolios based on investor risk profiles
- Automated portfolio recommendations by building ML pipelines that combined alternative financial data and generative AI, removing manual allocation decisions

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

Gamecock Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning

Active Member

November 2024 – Present

- Build and train machine learning models in a student team and apply them to place in applied AI competitions

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Programming:** Python, SQL, R
- **Machine Learning:** XGBoost, LightGBM, CatBoost, Random Forest, scikit-learn, TensorFlow, SHAP
- **Generative AI:** OpenAI API, Claude API, Prompt Engineering, AI Agents, Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG)
- **Developer Tools:** Claude Code, Codex, Git, GitHub, VS Code, Jupyter
- **Data:** Snowflake, Pandas, NumPy, Feature Engineering, ETL Pipelines
- **Analytics:** Credit Risk Modeling, Predictive Modeling, Information Value (IV), Reject Inference, Calibration, Monte Carlo Simulation, Statistical Analysis
- **Cloud & Platforms:** AWS, Supabase, Railway, Power BI, Excel